

A Probe Into Wilayah And Its Social Dimensions



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A Probe Into Wilayah And Its Social Dimensions

Dr. Mohammad Ali Shomali

Translated by Seyyedeh Zahra MirFendereski

[Abstract](#)

The issue of wilayah is one of the most fundamental Islamic concepts in the Holy Quran and Islamic hadiths. The purpose of this article is twofold.

Firstly, it makes an effort to study the nature and meaning of wilayah and secondly, by studying the social aspects of wilayah, it aims to explain that wilayah (or muwalat) is a strong spiritual bond between believers and the Infallibles. As will be explained later on in the article, for believers wilayah produces the same fate and aims both in this world and the hereafter.

Contrary to what most people believe, wilayah is not just the relationship between each individual believer and the Prophet and Imams, rather it is the relationship between the community of believers as a whole and the Prophet and Imams and also the relationship amongst the believers themselves.

The wilayah of Allah (S.w.T.) and His walis creates a united society and an integrated body of believers who demonstrate love, devotion and dedication amongst themselves. This type of wilayah is the soul of Islam and is able to give spiritual life to the Islamic ummah and bring unity to it. This article examines issues such as the essential elements, hierarchical order and mutuality of wilayah, whether or not unbelievers are under the wilayah of Allah (S.w.T.), and also the social function of wilayah.

By doing so, one can improve one's understanding of wilayah and also take a small step towards strengthening religious brotherhood and achieving a society governed by wilayah.

Indeed, strengthening and reinforcing the relationship of wilayah amongst the followers of the Ahl al-Bayt ('a) results in the best conditions for achieving Islamic unity and furthermore, Islamic unity results in the ideal conditions for friendship and collaboration of all believers in God throughout the world.

The concept of wilayah has a great and very special status in the Holy Quran and Islamic hadiths. Many studies have been conducted, extended discussions have been held by commentators, theologians, and mystics and many works have been written about this issue. However, it seems that it is necessary to do much more, both from the theoretical and the practical aspects. In this article, we seek help from Allah (S.w.T.) in attempting to profoundly study the meaning and nature of wilayah from the theoretical point of view, and to illustrate that wilayah, by its very nature, is a matter which relates to the community and not just to individuals.

Limiting wilayah to a relationship between individuals and the Infallibles is not only incorrect according to Islamic principles, but also prevents fulfillment of some of the main functions of wilayah in a religious society.

The Meaning Of Wilayah

Wilayah has many different meanings, but it usually means guardianship, assistance or friendship. Accordingly, wali (in Arabic, the subjective noun derived from wilayah) or mawla (in Arabic, another subjective noun derived from the same root) means guardian, assistant, or friend. By examining verbal references and textual inferences, one can find out which meaning is intended. For example, in the following verse from the Holy Quran, Allah (S.w.T.) says:

إِنَّمَا وَلِيُّكُمُ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا الَّذِينَ يُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَيُؤْتُونَ الزَّكَاةَ وَهُمْ رَاكِعُونَ

“Your wali is only Allah, His messenger, and the faithful who maintain the prayer and give the alms while bowing down” (5:55)

In the above-mentioned verse, due to verbal and historical references (the specific historical circumstances of the sending down of the verse), wali cannot just mean assistant or friend, but rather it

conveys the idea of a guardian or the one whose orders must be obeyed or the one who has the right to take control of people. ¹In the following two verses, mawla also means guardian:

وَإِنْ تَوَلَّوْا فَاعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ مَوْلَاكُمْ ۖ نِعْمَ الْمَوْلَىٰ وَنِعْمَ النَّصِيرُ

“And if they turn away, then know that Allah is your Master (mawla): an excellent Master (mawla) and an excellent Helper!” (8:40)

وَجَاهِدُوا فِي اللَّهِ حَقَّ جِهَادِهِ ۚ هُوَ اجْتَبَاكُمْ وَمَا جَعَلَ عَلَيْكُمْ فِي الدِّينِ مِنْ حَرَجٍ ۚ مِلَّةَ أَبِيكُمْ إِبْرَاهِيمَ ۚ هُوَ سَمَّاكُمُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ مِنْ قَبْلُ وَفِي هَذَا لِيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ شَهِيدًا عَلَيْكُمْ وَتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ ۚ فَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتُوا الزَّكَاةَ وَاعْتَصِمُوا بِاللَّهِ هُوَ مَوْلَاكُمْ ۚ فَنِعْمَ الْمَوْلَىٰ وَنِعْمَ النَّصِيرُ

“...So maintain the prayer, give the alms, and hold fast to Allah. He is your Master (mawla) an excellent Master (mawla) and an excellent Helper.” (22:78)

In these two verses, both Allah (S.w.T.)’s guardianship and His assistance are emphasized. If mawla was supposed to mean ‘assistant’, the phrase ‘an excellent Helper’ would be a pointless repetition which served no purpose.

Are The Unbelievers Under The Wilayah Of Allah?

An important point in the Holy Quran is that on some occasions Allah (S.w.T.) is considered as the wali for the faithful and it is mentioned that the faithless (the unbelievers) do not have a mawla:

ذَٰلِكَ بِأَنَّ اللَّهَ مَوْلَى الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَأَنَّ الْكَافِرِينَ لَا مَوْلَىٰ لَهُمْ

“That is because Allah is the mawla of the faithful, and because the faithless have no mawla.”
2(47:11)

However, in other verses of the Holy Qur’an, Allah (S.w.T.) is considered to be the mawla of everyone, even the faithless. Thus, it is stated:

هُنَالِكَ تَبْلُو كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَّا أَسْلَفَتْ ۚ وَرُدُّوا إِلَى اللَّهِ مَوْلَاهُمُ الْحَقَّ ۚ وَضَلَّ عَنْهُمْ مَا كَانُوا يَفْتَرُونَ

“And they will be returned to Allah, their real mawla, and what they used to fabricate will forsake them.” (10:30)

هُنَالِكَ الْوَلَايَةُ لِلَّهِ الْحَقِّ ۚ هُوَ خَيْرٌ ثَوَابًا وَخَيْرٌ عُقْبًا

“There, all wilayah belongs to Allah.” (18:44)

In addition to the two verses mentioned above, there are other verses which state that the faithless have illegitimate and tyrannical mawlas or walis. For example, in Chapter 2, Al-Baqarah, verse 257, we read:

اللَّهُ وَلِيُّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا يُخْرِجُهُم مِّنَ الظُّلُمَاتِ إِلَى النُّورِ وَالَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَوْلِيَاوُهُمُ الطَّاغُوتُ يُخْرِجُونَهُم مِّنَ النُّورِ إِلَى الظُّلُمَاتِ أُولَٰئِكَ أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ ۖ هُمْ فِيهَا خَالِدُونَ

“Allah is the Wali of the faithful: He brings them out of darkness into light. As for the faithless, their walis are the Rebels, who drive them out of light into darkness. They shall be the inmates of the Fire, and they shall remain in it [forever].” (2: 144)

Also in Chapter 28, Al-Qasas, verse 41, these walis are described as those leaders who invite the faithless to the fire of Hell:

وَجَعَلْنَاهُمْ أَئِمَّةً يَدْعُونَ إِلَى النَّارِ ۚ وَيَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ لَا يُنصَرُونَ

“We made them leaders who invite to the Fire, and on the Day of Resurrection they will not receive any help.” (28:41)

By conducting an in-depth analysis of these three kinds of verses, the following points can be deduced:

1. Allah (S.w.T.) is the Guardian (Wali) of the faithful amongst the people, and so, because the faithful also put themselves under His guardianship by their own free will, He guides them and helps them, supports them through difficult times and circumstances and brings them to their destination.
1. Allah (S.w.T.) is also the Guardian (Wali) of the faithless. Their existence and all aspects of their lives depend on divine blessings just like all other creatures.
2. Using their free will in the wrong way, the faithless hand over control to those who are neither guided, nor can direct others, and who are neither supported, nor can support others, instead of to Allah (S.w.T.). The faithless have chosen tyrants and evil powers as

their walis, those who are neither beneficial to them nor are capable of doing anything to help them in this life or in the hereafter. The Holy Qur'an states:

أَمْ اتَّخَذُوا مِنْ دُونِهِ أَوْلِيَاءَ ۚ قَالَ لَهُ هُوَ الْوَلِيُّ وَهُوَ يُحْيِي الْمَوْتَىٰ وَهُوَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

“Have they taken walis besides Him? [Say,] “It is Allah, who is the Wali, and He revives the dead, and He has power over all things.” (42:9)

3. Only the faithful have a mawla who loves them for their own sake and helps them without any expectations. However, false leaders invite their followers to the Fire of Hell due to their selfishness and self-interest.[3](#)

It is important to note that we have all been given free will by Allah (S.w.T.) and it is entirely up to us to make responsible choices throughout our lives, for example, as in the above case, regarding the kind of people we choose as our guardians to protect, support and help us.

Hierarchical Order Of Wilayah

Throughout history, Allah, the Exalted, who is the Wali and Mawla of the faithful, has chosen certain people as walis for them due to His Grace and Blessing. For example, He chose the Holy Prophet (S) and his rightful successors as the walis for the people of the final stage of life in this world. Allah (S.w.T.) appointed them to guide and help people. It is important to note that this kind of wilayah is subordinate to Allah (S.w.T.)'s wilayah and not at the same level. The Holy Qur'an disproves any kind of partnership with Allah:

وَقُلِ الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي لَمْ يَتَّخِذْ وَلَدًا وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ شَرِيكٌ فِي الْمُلْكِ وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ وَلِيٌّ مِنَ الذَّلِيلِ ۚ وَكَبِّرْهُ تَكْبِيرًا

“And say, “All praise belongs to Allah, who has neither taken any son, nor has He any partner in sovereignty, nor has He [taken] any wali out of weakness,” and magnify Him with a magnification [worthy of Him].” (17: 111)

أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ لَهُ مُلْكُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ ۚ وَمَا لَكُمْ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ مِنْ وَلِيٍّ وَلَا نَصِيرٍ

“Do you not know that to Allah belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth? And besides Allah you do not have any wali or any helper.” (2: 107)[4](#)

While other verses state:

إِنَّمَا وَلِيُّكُمُ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا الَّذِينَ يُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَيُؤْتُونَ الزَّكَاةَ وَهُمْ رَاكِعُونَ

“Your wali is only Allah, His Apostle, and the faithful who maintain the prayer and give the zakat while bowing down.” (5:55)

وَمَا لَكُمْ لَا تُقَاتِلُونَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَالْمُسْتَضْعَفِينَ مِنَ الرِّجَالِ وَالنِّسَاءِ وَالْوِلْدَانِ الَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ رَبَّنَا أَخْرِجْنَا مِنْ هَذِهِ الْقَرْيَةِ الظَّالِمِ أَهْلُهَا وَاجْعَلْ لَنَا مِنْ لَدُنْكَ وَلِيًّا وَاجْعَلْ لَنَا مِنْ لَدُنْكَ نَصِيرًا

“...and appoint for us a wali from You, and appoint for us a helper from You” (4:75)

فَهَبْ لِي مِنْ لَدُنْكَ وَلِيًّا يَرِثُنِي وَيَرِثُ مِنْ آلِ يَعْقُوبَ ۖ وَاجْعَلْهُ رَبِّ رَضِيًّا

“...So, grant me from Yourself wali (an heir)” (19:5)

Who may inherit from me and inherit from the House of Jacob, and make him, my Lord, pleasing to You.” (19:6)

Arabic linguists and people with appropriate knowledge understand the difference between the two phrases "min dun" (which in Arabic means "beside") and "min ladun" (which in Arabic means "from") in the above verses. If it was "beside Allah" ("min dunillah" in Arabic), it would be incorrect from the point of view of Allah (S.w.T.)'s Dignity.

But the phrase "from You" ("min ladunka" in Arabic) precisely denotes dignity and even brings honour to the slaves and thus is surely not in conflict with Allah (S.w.T.)'s Dignity. This wilayah indicates that Allah (S.w.T.), out of His Mercy, has appointed his walis "who make mighty the walis and abase the enemies"⁵ in order to pave the way towards dignity for the faithful.

Originally Might and Glory belong to Allah (S.w.T.) Alone:

الْعِزَّةُ لِلَّهِ جَمِيعًا

Indeed, all might belongs to Allah” (10:65)

And then they belong to Allah's walis such as the Holy Prophet (S) and the faithful:

...وَاللَّهُ الْعِزَّةُ وَلِرَسُولِهِ وَلِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ

“Yet all might belong to Allah and His Apostle, and the faithful...” (63:8).

Those who take the faithless as their walis are in fact seeking might, but they will not find it:

الَّذِينَ يَتَّخِذُونَ الْكَافِرِينَ أَوْلِيَاءَ مِنْ دُونِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ ۚ أَيْبَتُهُمْ عِنْدَهُمُ الْعِزَّةُ فَإِنَّ الْعِزَّةَ لِلَّهِ جَمِيعًا

“-- those who take the faithless for walis instead of the faithful. Do they seek might with them? [If so], indeed all might belongs to Allah.” (4: 139)

Wilayah Is Mutual

Another important point about the word wilayah and its derivatives is that they are used in a sense of mutuality. For example, in the following verse, to believe in the wilayah of Allah, the Holy Prophet and his successors (the chief amongst whom was the Commander of the Faithful, ‘Ali (‘a) who gave zakat while bowing down, according to a previously quoted verse) is called tawalli in Arabic, which means to take as wali:

وَمَنْ يَتَوَلَّ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا فَإِنَّ حِزْبَ اللَّهِ هُمُ الْغَالِبُونَ

“Whoever takes for his walis Allah, His Messenger and the faithful [should know that] the walis of Allah are indeed the victorious.” (5:56)

According to this verse, the faithful are walis for Allah (S.w.T.), the Holy Prophet (S) and his successors (‘a). Again, in another verse, undertaking wilayah (guardianship) of the righteous by Allah (S.w.T.) is also called "Tawalli" in Arabic, which means to take as wali:

إِنَّ وَلِيَّيَ اللَّهِ الَّذِي نَزَّلَ الْكِتَابَ ۖ وَهُوَ يَتَوَلَّى الصَّالِحِينَ

“My wali is indeed Allah who sent down the Book, and He takes wilayah of the righteous.” (7: 196)

According to this usage, Allah (S.w.T.) is the Wali of the faithful (the righteous). So Tawalli (to take as wali) is mutual in that Allah (S.w.T.) is the Wali of the faithful:

“Allah is the Wali of the faithful” (2:257)

And also true believers are Allah (S.w.T.)’s walis:

“Look! The friends (walis) of Allah will indeed have no fear nor will they grieve.” (10:62)

In Tafsir Nemuneh, the following explanation is given for the above verse:

Awliya' (walis in Arabic] is the plural form of wali which is derived from "wilayah" (in Arabic, the infinitive form of wali in the past tense, normally taken as the original root of the verb), "yaliy" (the infinitive form of wali in the present tense). The original root of the verb means that no intermediate agent exists between two things which are successive. For this reason, everything or everyone that is close to another, whether by place, time, genealogy (family) or status, is called wali. And this is the reason that the word wali is used for guardian, friend and so on.

So, Allah's walis are those for whom there is no kind of obstacle or any distance between them and Allah (S.w.T.). These are the ones from whose hearts all veils have been removed and in the light of knowledge, faith and good deeds, they see Allah (S.w.T.) (with their heart) in such a way that there remains no doubt for them...[6](#)

The Holy Prophet (S) and the Imams ('a) are our walis and if we accept them as our walis, we are also their walis. Perhaps it is for this reason that the Arabic verbal mode of mufa'alah (a verbal mode in Arabic which normally indicates that an action is mutual) is frequently used to indicate a mutual relationship between the Holy Prophet (S) and the Imams ('a) on the one hand and us on the other hand. For example, in the sermon of Ghadir, the Holy Prophet (S) stated: "For whomsoever I was mawla, 'Ali (S) is then his mawla. O' Allah! Take the one as wali (or mawla) who takes him as his wali and consider the one as your enemy who considers him as an enemy."[7](#)

So muwalat (taking as wali) is a mutual relationship. In the prayer which follows Ziyarat Al Yasin, we implore Allah (S.w.T.) to: "Grant me devotion filled with the light of taking Muhammad (S) and his Household ('a) as walis."

When somebody or something is close to another in such a way that there is nothing between them as an obstacle, the root verb wilayah (infinitive form in the past tense) and yaliyu (infinitive form in the present tense) are used in Arabic to form other derivatives from them. For example, a derived verb form of them is used in the following verse from the Holy Quran:

"...the faithless who live in your vicinity" (9: 123)

This denotes those faithless people who are living near Muslims without any other tribes or groups between them and the Muslims. If we wanted to emphasize the mutuality of the wilayah relationship, we would use its verbal mode of mufaalah (which was mentioned and explained above). With respect to the faithless it is not right to use muwalat, because although Allah (S.w.T.) is close to them, they are far from Him and so there is no such mutual relationship of muwalat. But in the case of the believers, where Allah (S.w.T.) is their Mawla and they are His Mawla, then there is a mutual relationship of muwalat. The relationship between believers and the Infallibles is also mutual. They are walis for the believers:

"Your guardian is only Allah, His Apostle, and the faithful who maintain the prayer and give the zakat while bowing down." (5:55)

And also their mawlas as in: "Whomever I was his mawla, then 'Ali is his mawla"⁸ And the believers can tell them: "I am a wali for you."⁹

"I am a mawla for you and I am among your followers."¹⁰ Ayatollah Misbah explains this issue as follows: Sometimes when two things are close to one another, the wilayah relationship is mutual. For example, the Qur'an says:

"But the faithful, men and women, are walis of one another." (9:71).

Every believer is the wali for another, and vice versa, while both of them have influence over each other. The relationship between Allah (S.w.T.) and the believers is of the same kind. On the one hand we have: ***"Allah is the wali of the faithful..." (2:257).*** While on the other hand we have: ***"Look! The walis of Allah..." (10:62)*** So, Allah is the Wali of the faithful and also the faithful are walis of Allah.¹¹

Elsewhere, he states: Thus, the relationship of wilayah is mutual and both sides influence each other. Naturally when two friends have common beliefs and emotions, they influence each other's behaviour:

"But the faithful, men and women, are comrades of one another." (9:71).

Both sides are walis for each other and both influence each other. However, it is not only amongst mankind and sometimes this relationship is formed between "Allah" and "mankind".¹²

Note: It should be noted that the mutuality of the relationship does not necessarily mean the equality of the two sides in this relationship. Certainly, wilayah of Allah (S.w.T.) over the believers differs from the believers' wilayah with Allah (S.w.T.). And also the wilayah of divinely appointed leaders i.e. the Prophet and the Imams over the believers differs from the wilayah of the believers with them. One side is the leader and the other side is the disciple. One is to be obeyed and the other is obedient. One is guiding and the other is receiving guidance. But so much love, closeness and mutual understanding exists between the two sides that it is as if there is a kind of reciprocity and partnership in this relationship.¹³

Essential Elements Of Wilayah

Now, we will briefly study the essential elements of wilayah. The author has been thinking for a long time about the essence and nature of our wilayah relationship with Allah (S.w.T.), His Apostle (S) and the Ahl al-Bayt ('a). Although the author considers himself to be very far from a thorough comprehension of this issue, he does believe that wilayah has three essential elements: Love and devotion, Knowledge, Obedience.

Wilayah is not regarded as any common or usual kind of guardianship or mastery. There must be devotion, sincerity and true-heartedness between different parties involved in wilayah. When one considers Allah (S.w.T.) or His Apostle (S) as his wali, most surely it does not mean guardianship of the kind practiced by worldly rulers or tyrannical leaders, who rule only over bodies and not over souls. As

was mentioned before, although Allah (S.w.T.) is in one sense the Wali for all beings in creation, however, He allowed mankind to choose a wali for himself in a responsible manner and thus the believer is the one who, through knowledge and love, chooses Allah (S.w.T.) as his Wali. Therefore, based on Allah (S.w.T.)'s blessed command, he will then benefit from the wilayah of Allah (S.w.T.)'s Apostle (S) and his successors ('a).

The kind of knowledge meant here is considered to be far deeper than the usual knowledge or understanding that exists between any superior and his inferior or even between two neighbors or colleagues; which is normally nothing more than the common knowledge without which no relationship can be formed. The knowledge which is meant here is the one that is sometimes called the "truth of knowledge".

It is comprehensive and at the same time so profound and effective that the one who possesses it cannot disregard or disobey what or whom the knowledge is about. In other words, the true believer who accepts wilayah, knows his walis i.e. Allah (S.w.T.), then His Apostle (S) and then the Imams ('a) to the best of his ability. He then becomes captivated and enthralled by them,¹⁴ organizes his life based on obedience to them, ¹⁵respects and attends to their will before his own¹⁶ and eventually considers their pleasure as his own.¹⁷

When the above explanation is taken into consideration, it becomes clear why it is of utmost importance to know the "Imam of the Age ('a)".¹⁸ "Knowing the Imam of the Age ('a)" would not merely involve the kind of common knowledge that everyone could have at any time. Knowing the Imam of the Age ('a) means knowing the personality and teachings of the Imam ('a), knowing his age and knowing what the Imam ('a) wants us to do in different situations and circumstances. This kind of knowledge can be the preliminary step towards action for everyone and can lead both individuals and society as a whole to success and happiness.

Collective Nature Of Wilayah

Following on from, and in addition to, the issues discussed previously, this paper will introduce and explain the idea that wilayah is a close spiritual bond between believers and the Infallibles which binds their destinies in this world and in the hereafter. Contrary to what many people think, wilayah is not the relationship between individual believers and the Prophet and the Imams, but rather it is the relationship between all believers and them and also amongst the believers themselves. For example, in our time, Imam Mahdi ('a) is the wali of all the believers, and also the believers are his walis and each other's' as well:

"But the faithful, men and women, are walis of one another: they bid what is right and forbid what is wrong and maintain the prayer, give the alms, and obey Allah and His Apostle. It is they to whom Allah will soon grant His mercy. Indeed, Allah is all-Mighty, all-Wise." (9:71)

“Indeed, those who have believed and migrated and waged jihad with their possessions and persons in the way of Allah, and those who gave [them] shelter and help, they are walis of one another. As for those who have believed but did not migrate, you have no wilayah with them whatsoever until they migrate...” (8:72).

Unbelievers also have leaders and they are walis for their leaders and for each other:

"As for the faithless, they are walis of one another..." (8:73)

"...Indeed, the wrongdoers are walis of one another, but Allah is the Wali of the god wary." (45: 19)

The destinies of unbelievers and their leaders are also tied to one another. Those who follow a leader in this world, take him as wali, and also take each other as walis, will be gathered together in the Hereafter and will be led together to Heaven or Hell. The Holy Quran states:

“The day We shall summon every group of people with their imam, then whoever is given his book in his right hand they will read it, and they will not be wronged so much as a single date-thread.” (17:71)

Commenting on this verse, ‘Allamah Tabatabai states: “We can understand from the verse that it is about Pharaoh, one of the leaders who led people astray:

"On the Day of Resurrection he will lead his people and conduct them into the Fire: an evil goal for the incoming!" (11:98)

And also from the following verse:

"So that Allah may separate the bad ones from the good, and place the bad on one another, and pile them up together, and cast them into hell..." (8:37)

Also, from many other verses, it is understood that people who go astray never become separated from their walis. The inevitable result of such a belief is that they will be gathered accompanying their leaders on the Day of Judgment... therefore the apparent understanding would be that the imam of every group is the one whom is taken by those people as their wali, whether he is the imam of the Right or the imam of the Wrong.”[19](#)

‘Allamah Tabatabai quotes a hadith from Imam Sadiq (‘a) which is cited in Tafsir Burhan from Ibn Shahr Ashub which says: “Do you not praise Allah? On the Day of Resurrection, He will summon all groups to join whom they have taken as their walis. We will join the Apostle of God (S) and you will join us.”[20](#)

In Tafsir Nemuneh, the same hadith goes on saying: “Where do you think you will be taken? By the Lord of Ka‘bah, to Heaven. (Imam (‘a) repeated the last sentence three times.)”[21](#)

‘Allamah Tabatabaei also quotes from Tafsir ‘Ayashi that Imam Sadiq (‘a) commented on the verse 71 of

Chapter Isra' by saying: "On the Day of Resurrection Allah will ask: Does not your God's justice necessitate separating people according to whom they have taken as their walis? They will answer: Yes." Then Imam Sadiq ('a) said: "Then Allah will order them to be separated from each other and they will do so."[22](#)

The Holy Qur'an states about the faithless:

"The faithless will be driven to hell in throngs..." (39:71)

And also about the faithful:

"Those who are wary of their Lord will be led to paradise in throngs..." (39:73)

There is much evidence regarding this matter. Thus, relationships by blood, through marriage and all other customary and conventional ones come to an end when we experience death. Then every person as an individual is responsible before Allah (S.w.T.):

"And each of them will come to Him individually on the Day of Resurrection." (19:95)

"Certainly you have come to Us alone, just as We created you the first time, and left behind whatever We had bestowed on you. We do not see your intercessors with you —those whom you claimed to be [Our] partners in [deciding] you[r] [fate]. Certainly, all links between you have been cut, and what you used to claim has forsaken you!" (6:94)

Depending on the way a person lives in this world and the wali he takes, he will be gathered into the group with which he is most in harmony and fits the most and then will follow his leader towards Heaven or Hell.

Furthermore, it should be realized that the love and devotion between the faithful and their leaders, and also amongst the faithful themselves will last and they will also receive much help from Allah (S.w.T.) and from the righteous leaders in His court. However, the faithless, even if grouped together, will receive no kindness or devotion from each other:

"On that day, friends will be one another's enemies, except for the god wary." (43:67)

Indeed, the faithless will implore Allah (S.w.T.) to give their friends more punishment:

"He will say, 'Enter, along with the nations who passed before you of jinn and humans, into the Fire!' Every time that a nation enters [hell], it will curse its sister [nation]. When they all rejoin in it, the last of them will say about the first of them, 'Our Lord, it was they who led us astray; so give them a double punishment of the Fire.' He will say, 'It is double for each [of you], but you do not know.'" (7:38)

The leaders of the wrongdoers will denounce their followers:

“When those who were followed will disown the followers, and they will sigh the punishment while all their means of recourse will be cut off.” (2: 166)

When the followers become aware of their leaders’ powerlessness and denouncement of them, they will also want to denounce their leaders:

“And when the followers will say, ‘Had there been another turn for us, we would disown them as they disown us [now]!’ Thus, shall Allah show them their deeds as regrets for themselves, and they shall not leave the Fire.” (2: 167)

It is important to note that when the followers experience their leaders’ unkindness and denouncement of them, instead of saying that they will now denounce their leaders, they will say, “Would that we could return to the world to denounce our misguided leaders as they have now done to us.”

It might mean that they know that it is too late to denounce their leaders. They spent their whole lives following those who never really loved them and just used them for their own benefit. And then they will all go down into the depths of the Hell together and will not be able to separate themselves from each other.

The Social Function Of Wilayah

In this section, we will study what the faithful are like and how the wilayah of Allah (S.w.T.) creates unity amongst them in such a way that in all situations, whether in times of comfort or hardship, in this world or the hereafter, they always think about each other, love each other and they are quite willing to sacrifice their lives, property and time not only for their walis, but also for their sisters and brothers in religion. This is what they learn from their leaders, who are the exemplars of loyalty and kindness and are not neglectful of their followers even for a moment.

We should carefully consider why the Holy Prophet (S) stated: “The faithful are like components of one building where each part supports another.” And “The faithful are like one soul.” And “Friendship and compassion of the faithful make them like parts of one body; when some parts are in pain, the other parts would not be at rest.”[23](#)

It is wilayah that makes an integrated and fully functioning body out of the faithful. It is wilayah that melts any kind of self-centeredness and egotism and causes love and self-sacrifice to flourish. Wilayah is the spirit and soul of Islam and it can give spiritual life to Islamic communities.

In what follows, we will study some important teachings from the most well-known supplications and Ziyarats concerning this issue:

Ziyarat 'Ashura

In Ziyarat 'Ashura we find very profound ideas about the way the faithful should relate to each other and form a very united and homogenous community. For example, in one place we read: "O' Aba 'Abdillah! Indeed, I am at peace with whoever is at peace with you and I am at war with whoever makes war with you, until the Day of Resurrection."

What is emphasized in this part of Ziyarat 'Ashura is that taking wilayah of the Imam ('a) must have two results: to love his friends and to fight against his enemies. Therefore, it is by no means enough that one just loves Imam Husayn ('a) and considers e.g. Yazid as an enemy, rather one must love their friends and makes efforts to remain always at peace with those who are at peace with them forever, right up until the Day of Resurrection. This is the real challenge; otherwise just to love the Ahl al-Bayt ('a) is not difficult. The only time one should be able to claim that one loves the Ahl al-Bayt ('a) is when one loves their friends and by no means harms or hurts them.

In another part we implore: "O' Aba 'Abdillah! Indeed I seek closeness to Allah and His Apostle and to the Commander of the Faithful ('a) and to Fatimah ('a) and to Hasan ('a) and to you through wilayah with you and by denouncing the ones who martyred you and those who made war with you and through denouncing those who laid the foundations and those who built upon them and carried out oppression and cruelty upon you all and upon your followers."

In this part of the ziyarat, the way of seeking nearness to Allah (S.w.T.), the Holy Prophet (S) and his Household ('a) is considered to be through taking wilayah of Imam Husayn ('a) and denouncing those who fought against him and whoever laid the foundations for oppressing the Household ('a) and it becomes clear that this denunciation also includes those who oppress the followers of the Imams ('a). So, the issue is not confined to Karbala or to those in Imam Husayn ('a)'s army and Yazid's army. It is not even confined to the early stages of Islam and those on the side of the Household of the Prophet ('a) and those on the opposition's side; but rather this positioning will continue until the Day of Resurrection and will be repeated in all lands that are like Karbala and at all times throughout history which are like 'Ashura. This is why we say: "All days are 'Ashura and all lands are Karbala".

Therefore, everyone must be very careful not to do any injustice to any person, since this is one of the greatest sins in Islam and everyone must be extraordinarily careful not to do injustice to the followers of the Ahl al-Bayt ('a) since this is considered by the Ahl al-bayt ('a) as an act of injustice against themselves, no matter whether the person who is unjust claims to be himself one of their followers or not.

Immediately following the above section, when the supplicant has had some mental preparation, he states: "...and I seek nearness to Allah and then to you through wilayah with you and your friends and through denouncing your enemies and those who fought against you and denouncing their adherents and followers."

In the above section, the way of seeking nearness to Allah, the Holy Prophet (S) and his Household ('a) is considered to be through taking wilayah of the Holy Prophet (S) and his Household ('a) and wilayah of their friends and their followers and through denouncing the enemies of the Household ('a), their followers and their friends. So, one important factor in seeking nearness to Allah (S.w.T.) and the Household ('a) is befriending and taking wilayah of their followers. Then, following on from the above section, the section mentioned first is repeated again with the addition of an important issue:

“Surely, I am at peace with those who are at peace with you, and I am at war with those who are at war with you; and I am a wali of those who are in wilayah with you and an enemy to those who are enemies to you.”

Then we implore Allah regarding some requests: “So then I ask Allah, who has honored me with recognition of all of you and recognition of your walis and has also granted me the opportunity to denounce your enemies, that He places me with you, both in this world and the hereafter, and that He makes firm my honest and truthful stance in your presence both in this world and in the hereafter. And I ask Him (Allah) that He enables me to reach the most praised station that you have with Allah and that He grants me the ability to seek justice for those who shed your blood with the rightly guided Imam, who shall surely reappear and speak the truth.”

Thus, for the four requests we implore Allah (S.w.T.), “who has honored me with recognition of all of you and recognition of your walis and has also granted me the opportunity to denounce your enemies”. These requests must be related to knowing the Household ('a) and their walis as well as denouncement of their enemies. Generally, when we call on Allah (S.w.T.) using one of His Attributes and then ask for something or when we implore Him for something and then praise Him with some of His Attributes, there should be some form of correlation between the request and the Attribute. For example, it is stated in the Holy Qur'an:

“Say, ‘My Lord, forgive and have mercy, and You are the best of the merciful.’” (23: 118)

In this verse, there is a correlation between imploring for forgiveness and mercy and the attribute of mercifulness. Another example is:

“He said, ‘My Lord! Forgive me, and grant me a kingdom that does not befit anyone except me. Indeed You are the All-Munificent.’” (38:35)

Here there is a strong correlation between asking for forgiveness and a kingdom from Allah (S.w.T.) by appealing to His Munificence. The same can be said about the following verse:

“...and turn to us clemently. Indeed You are the All- Clement, the All-Merciful.” (2: 118)

So it can be concluded that having recognition of the Household ('a) and their walis and denouncing their enemies are necessary for the fulfillment of those four requests. In fact, we implore Allah (S.w.T.), who

has bestowed the above-mentioned three prerequisites, to grant us our demands and show us His Mercy. The four requests are to be with the Household ('a) in this world and the hereafter.

To stand firm and be on the right path with the Household ('a). To achieve the praiseworthy status that the Household ('a) have before Allah (S.w.T.). To take revenge for the blood of the Household ('a) in the company of the Imam of our Time ('a)

To be with the Household ('a) in this world does not mean physically being with them; for it is not possible during the Time of Concealment, nor was it achievable for many Shi'as even at other times. Furthermore, it might even be quite unpleasant if everyone wanted to go to the residence of the Imams ('a) and live there. In view of what was mentioned before, it seems that knowing the

Household ('a) and more specifically the Imam of our Time ('a) means that we know the Imam ('a), the time, and the Imam's ('a) aims and goals at this time. We should know the faithful and those who have his wilayah and we should have enough knowledge about their condition, needs, potentials and their efforts. We also have to know our enemies and keep away from their plans and actions (by denouncing them) and by generally keeping away from associating with them. If we do all these things, then we can be hopeful of being considered as being with the Household ('a) in this world and the hereafter, remaining on the right path and not going astray and then in the end being gathered together with the Household ('a) on the Day of Resurrection. As we read: "To be assembled with you ('a)"[24](#)

Our ultimate goal is to follow the Holy Prophet (S) and his Household ('a) when entering Heaven and to live where they live. Before then, our short-term wish is to be beside Imam Mahdi ('a), whether alive or resurrected, at his service and not against him when he ('a) starts his movement: ".....in your return and in your government"[25](#)

"O Allah! If death occurs between me and him (before his reappearance) death which You have made necessary and decreed for your servants, then raise me from my grave, wrapped in my shroud, my sword unsheathed, my spear bared, answering the call of the caller in cities as well as deserts."[26](#)

If the faithful are like one body, united and gathered around the wali of Allah (S.w.T.) or his deputies, and support each other from the heart in word and deed, happiness will surely be granted to them in this world and the hereafter. Furthermore, the bitter period of separation and the Time of Concealment will pass and the sweet time of reappearance and union will come; about which Imam Mahdi ('a) has stated: "Surely, if our Shi'as – may Allah help them for their obedience to Him – were united in their hearts securely on [their] promises [with us], there would not be any delay in [the blessing of] meeting us."[27](#)

It is very likely that if the Shi'as are separated and disconnected, they will be surrounded by calamities and deviations and their enemies who appear to be friends and 'wolves in sheep's clothing' will hunt them down.

Du'a Of Nudbah

In that part of the Du'a of Nudbah where the prayers reach fever pitch and total enlightenment and the supplicant adoringly implores Imam Mahdi ('a), he says: Is there any helper with whom I can prolong my weeping and lamenting? Is there any lonely mourner whom I may accompany in mourning when he mourns in private? Is there any eye in pain for you like an eye pricked by thorn so that my eye can help it with tears?

Although weeping and crying about something might be considered a private and personal matter; however here we are being taught that even in this situation, if we want to express our feelings, we should seek out people with the same beliefs as our own with whom we could then cry more. It does not just mean that when a group of people cry together their combined weeping will be more effective than each individual's alone, but rather it means that when friends cry and weep in each other's company, everyone can cry more and also for longer. This is the fruit of teamwork that increases the efficiency of each individual.

The next question is: "Is there any lonely mourner whom I may accompany in mourning when he mourns in private?" So this is not just a matter of being limited to reading the Dua of Nudbah in the mosque or other places. In addition to their social relationships in general, the Shi'a should be aware of each other's personal lives in order to share their needs and ideas and thus be allowed in each other's private lives.

It is narrated that once a person called Barid 'Ijli said to Imam Baqir ('a): "You have many followers in Kufah. If you order them, they will obey and follow you." Imam ('a) stated:

"Can every one of them put his hand into the pocket of his brother in faith when in need, and thus eliminate his need?" He answered: "No." Imam ('a) stated: "So (if they are mean and niggardly amongst themselves concerning their possessions) they would be even more niggardly about their lives."²⁸ It is interesting that the Imam tests their obedience and loyalty towards himself by asking how much they are ready to share their possessions with their brothers and sisters in faith.

Continuing with the Du'a of Nudbah, after that it is asked: "Is there any eye in pain for you like an eye pricked by thorn so that my eye can help it with tears?" The important point here is

that the request for a helper is made once, whilst the announcement of readiness to help is made twice. The sign of a decent society is that its people's readiness to provide help to other people is more than their expectation of receiving help from others, even for important, public goals. Whilst in an unhealthy society, even if its people work for the sake of religion (or think that they do so), firstly each person only cares about his own job, secondly he considers his own job as the most important of all and thirdly although he expects everyone else to help him, yet he is not willing to make any effort for other people or offer any of his own facilities to others.

Many different parts of the Du'a of Nudbah raise the idea of the spirit of teamwork and care for others. The supplicant is not only seeking to fulfill his own personal needs, but also prays for others. For example, we read: "Will we be able shortly to come over to you on your reappearance to which we eagerly look forward? When will we be able to drink from your streams (of benevolence) to quench our thirst (for your benevolence)?"

When shall you see us and we see you whilst you have unfurled the banner of Islam for victory, at the same time seeing us gathered around you when we, with utmost sincerity (out of love and affection for you), have gathered around you and you are leading the masses? At that time we see you having filled the earth with justice.

So, O Allah! Convey to him from us our sincere greetings and salutations and through these greetings, O our Lord, enhance our honour; and make his place (in Paradise) a home and resting place for us; and give him precedence over us in completing Your Bounties on him until You grant us a place in Your Paradise and the companionship of martyrs from among the pure and sincere people."

The supplicant's requests are for the establishment of truth, the elimination of falsehood, dignity for the walis of Allah (S.w.T.) and debasement of His enemies, remaining on the right path and not being separated from the Household ('a):

"O Allah! Through him (Imam) establish the truth and through him destroy falsehood and through him guide those who are close to You and through him disgrace Your enemies.

O Allah! Establish such a relationship and love between us and him (our Imam) that will give us the honour of the company of his ancestors. And let us be of those who always seek their company and stay permanently under their shelter."

Du'A Al-'Ahd

The spirit of teamwork is also strongly felt in Du'a al-'Ahd. This becomes clear where, for example, the supplicant as a Shi'a of Imam Mahdi ('a) implores Allah (S.w.T.) to bless his wali ('a). Here we see that he does not only care about himself, or at most, his parents, but before himself and his family, he cares about the faithful men and women everywhere around the world and implores Allah (S.w.T.) thus: "O Allah, convey to our master, the leader, the guide, the guided, he who rises by Your Command, blessings of Allah be upon him and his pure forefathers from the believing men and women in the east of the earth and its west, in its plains and its mountains, its lands and its seas, and from me and my parents, blessings which weigh as much as of Allah's throne and ink of His words, and whatever His knowledge enumerates and His book encompasses."

How many believers would there have been in the east and the west of the known world when this supplication was taught by Imam Sadiq ('a)? How many Shi'a were there in China for example? How

many believers travelled on the seas or how many of them were living beyond the seas? Would it not appear that Imam ('a) wanted to tell you and me that it is seriously expected from us, the Shi'a during the Time of Concealment, who live in an age of propagation and participation in Shi'a societies around the world, to begin our days thinking about the Imam of our Time, concerned about his Shi'a, considering ourselves as part of a whole and thinking about the ummah before making requests about our own personal matters?

At the end of this dua, we say: "O Allah! Remove this sorrow (of concealment) from this nation by his presence and hasten for us his reappearance. They (the disbelievers) consider it to be distant while we consider it to be near. For the sake of Your Mercy, O the Most Merciful of all the Merciful."

Dua Of Iftitah

The Dua of Iftitah, especially towards the end, is full of references to issues concerned with community and care for society and the world which relate to the entire body engaged in wilayah. It is sufficient to read the section below to justify the above claim:

"O' Allah, we ardently desire [his] honorable government, in which Thou should reactivate Islam and stimulate its followers, and humble and humiliate the imposters and their double dealing, and include us among those who invite people unto Thy obedience, and lead them to Thy approved path, and give us the good of this world and the world to come.

O' Allah, through him, set in order our disorder; gather and unite our flock; stitch together our sundered separation; turn our want and poverty into sufficiency; lift us up from our degradation; free us from our misery; pull us out from our debts; eradicate poverty amongst us.

O' Allah, we feel uneasy about and are disturbed by the departure of our Prophet, Thy blessings be on him and on his family, the absence of our wali, too many enemies, our numerical scarcity, widespread disorder, and the vicissitudes of time.

So send blessings on Muhammad and on his family, and help us to overcome this state of affairs at once. Disperse the ominous clouds hanging over our heads; lend a helping hand to achieve success; bring in the rule of justice and fair play, make us bright and free us from grief, and take us in Your Care. (It is possible) through Your Mercy, O the Most Merciful."

It is as if we are reading the articles of an association which set out its aims and objectives as well as its difficulties and their solutions. This is an association in which there is no selfishness, egotism, division and polarization, negligence regarding enemies, hopelessness or despair.

Ziyarat Amin Allah

Ziyarat Amin Allah is one of the most authentic and valid Ziyarats according to Shaykh ‘Abbas Qumi and ‘Allamah Majlisi and should be recited in all religious gatherings. It has an additional section which is found in Kamil al-Ziyarah. Jabir quoted from Imam Baqir (‘a) that once Imam Sajjad (‘a) prayed and declared beside the tomb of Imam Ali (‘a) that:

“O’ Allah, You are my God, Master and Wali. Forgive our friends and withhold our enemies from us and keep them so busy that they cannot bother us. And make the word of truth highest and make the word of falsehood lowest. Indeed, You have power over all things.”

The above sentences indicate that Imams (‘a) have great concern for their followers and also deep concern about the question of truth and falsehood in general. Thus, we must take both of these things into consideration: to be concerned about our friends and walis both in our prayers and in practice, and to spare no efforts in making truth prevail over the falsehood.

In a letter to Ishaq Neyshaburi, Imam ‘Askari (‘a) expressed his love and concern for his friends as follows: “May Allah (S.w.T.) bless you! Due to Allah’s Mercy, we are the family that constantly cares for our friends and we are happy when Allah’s Mercy and Blessings embrace them and we consider each gift bestowed on to them by Allah, the Exalted, as great. May Allah (S.w.T.) complete His Blessings upon you and your friends, and on whom Allah (S.w.T.) has had mercy upon and has shown the truth to them as He did to you.

They turn their face away from the falsehood and would not sink into transgression. And to complete the blessings upon you so that you may enter into Heaven. There is no blessing from God that saying Alhamdulillah (Praise be to Allah!) and praising Allah – Exalted be His names– does not serve as gratitude and thanking for it. So Then I say: Alhamdulillah as much as all the praises which one who praises would praise for the grace Allah (S.w.T.) has bestowed upon you and by which He has saved you from destruction ...”

What kind of love and devotion is it that makes Imams (‘a) care for their friends constantly? The pleasure of Shi’a makes Imams (‘a) happy and their hardships makes Imams (‘a) sad. They consider as great every gift bestowed by Allah (S.w.T.) on the shia, as great and know that they themselves are obliged to thank Allah (S.w.T.) because of those gifts and they implore Allah (S.w.T.) to complete His blessings upon the Shi’a by granting them permission to enter to Heaven. It would be even more interesting when we know that Ishaq Neyshaburi and his friends were not very good people with regards to Imam ‘Askari (‘a) and his father, Imam Hadi (‘a). In this letter which is filled with love and devotion for them, Imam (‘a) states:

“During the age of the previous Imam (‘a) and also during my lifetime up until now, you have undertaken actions which I disagree with. To which wrong things are you are being directed and to which destination

you are heading like animals? You turn your faces from the truth and believe in the falsehood and show ingratitude for the blessings from Allah.”²⁹

Imam (‘a), whose heart is so painful because of due to the bad actions of Ishaq Niyshaburi and his friends, still shows love towards them to the extent that even a father does not do towards his children. If the last part of the letter did not exist, one would suppose that the letter was addressed to the most sincere and devoted Shi’a.

In another letter, Imam ‘Askari (‘a) wrote to people of Qum as follows: “...Allah, the Exalted, joined you and us in a close relationship and made a kinship like relationship amongst us, for Imam Ridha’ (‘a) stated: ‘The faithful person is like a real brother in relationship to another person.”³⁰

We hope that this article, which used only a few of the many Islamic sources concerning the social aspect of wilayah, could be a step towards reinforcement of religious brotherhood which will then go further by taking other scientific and practical steps. Certainly, reinforcement and strengthening of the relationship of wilayah amongst the Shi’ites of the Household (‘a) will create the best possible conditions for Islamic unity in the same way that Islamic unity creates the best conditions for friendship and collaboration amongst believers all over the world.

Conclusion

In the present article, the meaning of wilayah was studied using the Holy Quran and hadiths. It became clear that wilayah is not just a relationship between individual believers and Allah (S.w.T.)’s walis, nor is it between individual believers and those who have wilayah. Wilayah is a social issue that is based on three essential elements: knowledge, love and obedience.

In other words, wilayah is a kind of strong spiritual bond which connects believers to the Infallibles (S.w.T.)’s representative (‘a) and enables them to have the same aim and destination in this world and the hereafter.

Wilayah is a relationship between all believers collectively and the Infallibles (‘a) and also amongst the believers themselves. Wilayah establishes a united society and an integrated body of believers which is ruled by the love and devotion amongst them.

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[1.](#) To see commentaries and hadiths regarding this verse refer to Al-Mizan fi Tafsir Al-Qur'an, vol. 6, pp. 5-25 and Tafsir-e Nemuneh, vol. 4, pp. 421-434.

[2.](#) "Mawla means wali, guardian, helper and friend." Tafsir-e Nemuneh, vol. 21, p. 429. The Holy Qur'an also states:

أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ لَهُ مُلْكُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ ۚ وَمَا لَكُمْ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ مِنْ وَلِيٍّ وَلَا نَصِيرٍ

"Do you not know that to Allah belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth? And besides Allah you do not have any wali or any helper." (1:107).

Many other verses also emphasize this issue.

[3.](#) The Holy Qur'an states:

"Whoever takes Satan as a guardian (wali) instead of Allah has certainly incurred a manifest loss." (4:119);

"Say, 'Shall I take for guardian (wali) [anyone] other than Allah, the originator of the heavens and the earth, who feeds and is not fed?'" (6:14).

"Who feeds and is not fed" could mean that Allah (S.w.T.) is the Benefactor but He is not a beneficiary.

[4.](#) Cf. 18:26, 29:22, 32:4, 42:31, ...

[5.](#) Dua of Nudbah

[6.](#) Tafsir-e-Nemuneh, vol 8, p. 333.

[7.](#) In these sentences 'taking as wali' is in the verbal mode of mufaalah which means this relation is mutual.

[8.](#) From the sermon of Ghadir.

[9.](#) Ziyarat Al-e-Yasin

[10.](#) Abu Basir's talk with Imam Baqir ('a) cf. Bihar al-Anwar, vol. 27, p. 30.

[11.](#) Dar Partu Wilayat (In the Light of Wilayah), p. 265.

[12.](#) In the book Dar Partu Wilayat (In the Light of Wilayah), pp. 290-291, the author emphasizes that the relationship of wilayah between Allah (S.w.T.) and mankind is mutual. Ayatollah Misbah then explains that Allah (S.w.T.) is not influenced by mankind and says:

"When the relationship of wilayah is formed between mankind and Allah, then could it mean that Allah influences us and we influence Him? The answer is clear: surely, in such a case, there could not exist any counter influencing. It is only Allah who influences us. The wilayah relationship between mankind and Allah means that man's knowledge grows to be the knowledge gained from Allah, his love becomes a kind of love Allah wants, his behavior becomes so and etc.

Then, in the wilayah relationship between mankind and Allah, Allah does not gain any influence from man; in fact, He does not gain any influence from any being. However, this wilayah is mutual as well...

Although in this case, wilayah is also mutual, the influence is just from one side. In other words, the connection between Allah and man is mutual, which means that Allah is close to man and vice versa, but influencing and gaining influence is not mutual." (Dar Partu Wilayat (In the Light of Wilayah), pp. 291 & 292)

[13.](#) This issue is more tangible when considering the relationship of muwalat between the Holy Prophet (S), the Imams ('a) and their followers, and it is emphasized more. However, Allah (S.w.T.) is so much higher in status in comparison to the

believers that one needs to be considerably more careful about the usage of words and thus the word ‘muwalat’ is used less, although both sides are walis for each other and sometimes the verbal mode of mufaalalah is even used (that Allah (S.w.T.) is grammatically subject and the believers are the object).

For example, in the sermon of Ghadir, the Holy Prophet (S) says this sentence about ‘Ali (‘a) “O Allah! Be the wali of whosoever is the wali of him [‘Ali (‘a)]”. In the case of the Imams and the believers because both the believers and the Imams (‘a) are human and created beings, one can talk more easily about the relationship between them and so the word ‘muwalat’ is used frequently.

[14.](#) Verse 35: 28 and other similar verses explain how knowledge leads to captivation with and awe of Allah (S.w.T.).

[15.](#) Verse 3: 31 and other similar verses explain how love and devotion lead to obedience.

[16.](#) Verse 33:6 and other similar verses explain how the right and will of the wali is prior to the right and will of one’s self.

[17.](#) Verse 4:65 and other similar verses indicate that the believer, in addition to obeying his wali, must be satisfied with his decision and must consider his wali’s will as prior to his own.

[18.](#) Referring to the prophetic hadith reported by all Islamic schools of thoughts: “One who dies and does not know the Imam of his age, has died of the Age of Ignorance”, ‘Allamah Majlisi considered this hadith as a mass reported hadith among all Islamic schools of thoughts. Cf. Bihar al-Anwar, vol. 8, p. 368.

[19.](#) Tarjomeh Al-Mizan, vol. 13, p. 229.

[20.](#) Al-Mizan fi Tafsir Al-Qur’an, vol. 13, p. 170.

[21.](#) Tafsir-e Nemuneh, vol. 12, pp. 204, 213.

[22.](#) Al-Mizan fi Tafsir Al-Qur’an, vol. 13, p. 171.

[23.](#) Tafsir-e Nemuneh, vol. 3, pp. 33.

[24.](#) Ziyarat Jami’ah Kabirah

[25.](#) Ziyarat Jami’ah Kabirah

[26.](#) Du’a al-‘Ahd

[27.](#) Bihar al-Anwar, vol. 53, p. 177

[28.](#) Bihar al-Anwar, vol. 52, p. 273.

[29.](#) Pishwayan-e Hidayat (the Leaders of Guidance), vol. 13, pp. 269–270.

[30.](#) Pishwayan-e Hidayat (the Leaders of Guidance), vol. 13, p. 277.

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